

# Founding members — pitch cards

*Memorize one spine. Swap one line. Everything else is conversation.*

## The spine — four beats, fifteen seconds

|           |                                                                                     |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 • OPEN  | "It's Craigslist, if everyone on it was vouched for."                               |
| 2 • SWAP  | The angle line for their type — the only beat that changes.                         |
| 3 • PROOF | "Your sponsor's name stays on your profile. People behave."                         |
| 4 • CLOSE | "Would you actually use this?" • "Who are the three Manhattanites you'd vouch for?" |

## The four motives — if you memorize only one thing

| MOTIVE | THE PERSON                     | TYPES                                               | THE MOVE                                      |
|--------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| PAIN   | Has suffered the alternative   | Movers, Newcomers                                   | <i>Tell their story back to them.</i>         |
| PRIDE  | Name and taste carry weight    | Locals, Connectors, Tastemakers                     | <i>Their name matters here.</i>               |
| SUPPLY | Has, or hears about, the goods | Landlords, Fixtures, Hospitality, Design, Creatives | <i>Their stuff finds a better room.</i>       |
| MODEL  | Wants to know why it works     | Finance, Tech, Media                                | <i>Trust built first, marketplace on top.</i> |

## The Raya variant

### “It’s Craigslist meets Raya.”

**WHO** The scene-literate New Yorker: 25–38, creative / media / fashion / music / hospitality, treats admission-by-vetting as normal. On the tracker: tastemakers, connectors, creatives, hospitality, the more social movers.

**THE TEST** Would they know Raya without explanation? If yes, use it. If you'd have to explain Raya, the line is dead — fall back to “vouched for.”

**THE CHASER** Never let the line travel alone: “...but the door isn't the point. Everything inside actually works — no scams, no flakes, no strangers.” People who join for the rope lurk; people who join for the marketplace post.

**NEVER** Don't say it to media — “Raya for Craigslist” is a ready-made headline and seed phase is no-press. Misfires on locals 40+, finance, landlords, newcomers.

## The cards

### Young professional / mover **PAIN**

**ANGLE** *“You know what it's like finding anything here — an apartment, a sofa, a subletter. Scams, flakes, noise. Imagine every listing came from someone vouched for by name.”*

**ASK** What are they hunting for or offloading right now? Apartment, furniture, anything — that becomes their first search or first listing.

**WATCH FOR** They convert on their own story. Ask “what's your worst marketplace story — Craigslist, Facebook, anywhere?” then land the one-liner on top of their answer.

### Established local **PRIDE**

**ANGLE** *“The first 20 members set the tone for everything after. I want people whose name means something here.”*

**ASK** Lean on question 2. They know exactly who they'd vouch for, and their vouches carry.

**WATCH FOR** Don't oversell. Confidence, not flattery. They join because it's serious, not because you need them.

### Newcomer to the city **PAIN**

**ANGLE** *“This is the network people spend ten years building — vouched apartments, furniture, intel — and you get it on day one.”*

**ASK** What are they hunting for right now?

**WATCH FOR** They may feel they have nothing to offer. Tell them: newcomers make the market. They're the buyers and the renters.

### Connector — knows everyone **PRIDE**

**ANGLE** *“Sponsorship is public. Everyone you bring in carries your name. You already make introductions for free — this gives them a home.”*

**ASK** Skip question 1, go straight to question 2. They'll offer ten names; take three.

**WATCH FOR** Their vouches are the growth engine, but hold the 5-invites-a-week ceiling even when they hand you a list.

### Neighbourhood fixture — shop / café / staff **SUPPLY**

**ANGLE** *“You hear about people moving before their landlord does. This is the place where that's worth something.”*

**ASK** Send the person, not the tip. When someone mentions moving out, that's an invite moment.

**WATCH FOR** This pitch happens across a counter, not over email. Keep it casual, keep it short.

## Apartment supply — landlord / buildings SUPPLY

ANGLE *“Every inquiry comes from someone vouched for by name. No anonymous strangers — you can see who brought them in.”*

ASK One vacancy or sublet as a first listing.

**WATCH FOR** Fair housing. The listing describes the apartment, never the wanted tenant. You approve or decline; you never rewrite.

## Tastemaker — has an audience PRIDE

ANGLE *“It's small on purpose, and the first 20 decide what it becomes. I'd rather have you shaping it than hearing about it later.”*

ASK Membership only. Do NOT ask them to post about it — seed phase is private.

**WATCH FOR** They can smell being wanted for reach. The pitch is being early, not being a channel.

## Creative — artist / musician / designer SUPPLY

ANGLE *“Artists already run on word of mouth — sublets, gear, spaces. This just gives it an address.”*

ASK First listing: the amp, the flat file, the summer sublet.

**WATCH FOR** Price sensitivity. Lead with “free to join, free to browse” before they have to ask.

## Design & interiors SUPPLY

ANGLE *“A marketplace where the furniture is actually good and the photos are taken like it matters. Your pieces deserve a better room.”*

ASK List one piece. Their photography sets the standard for the whole site.

**WATCH FOR** Business accounts are out of MVP scope. Invite the person, not the studio. Client-offload pieces park until v2.

## Media / writer MODEL

ANGLE *“Tell the full 30-second version — the Gens de Confiance story. It's a good story and they'll enjoy it told well.”*

ASK “I'm not pitching coverage — that comes much later, if ever. I want you in it as a member.”

**WATCH FOR** Saying “no press yet” makes it more interesting to them, not less. The embargo is part of the pitch.

## Finance / business MODEL

**ANGLE** *“It filters the way you already filter everything — through people who stake their name on the recommendation.”*

**ASK** Question 2, hard. Their vouches tend to be fast and high quality.

**WATCH FOR** They'll ask about the business model. One line: “Pay-per-post later. Membership free forever.” Then move on.

## Tech / startup MODEL

**ANGLE** *“The skeptic version: “Every marketplace bolts trust on at the end. We built the trust first and the marketplace on top.””*

**ASK** Both questions work as written.

**WATCH FOR** “How does this scale?” is coming. The answer: “Slowly, on purpose.” The restraint is the model.

## Other / unclassified

**ANGLE** *“Default to the party version, then close with the two questions.”*

**ASK** If the conversation goes well, you'll know their motive by the end — retype them in the tracker.

**WATCH FOR** One-liner, their motive, the two questions. That's a complete pitch.

## Practice drill — 10 minutes

1. Say the spine out loud three times, until beats 1, 3, and 4 are automatic.
2. Shuffle: pick names off the tracker at random. Say the motive out loud, then the angle line.
3. Before each coffee: 60 seconds. Motive, angle line, tailored ask. Nothing else.

*If you forget everything mid-conversation: one-liner, their motive, the two questions. That's a complete pitch.*